

SD Terminal Information (Terminfo)

The terminfo database, the 63 definitions that ship, and the compiler that ships with them.

SD uses a terminfo database to know what byte sequences a terminal sends for each key, and what sequences to emit for screen control — cursor movement, clear, colour, bold, underline.

Most installations never touch it. The 63 shipped definitions cover the terminals in ordinary use, and `windows` works with any Windows console, cmd, PowerShell or Windows Terminal session.

The default terminal

```
term
```

```
Page width: 120
Page depth: 36
Device      : windows
```

The default terminal type is `windows`. This is an exact copy of the `linux` definition, which had the right byte sequences for Windows consoles, cmd, PowerShell and Windows Terminal.

Existing accounts keep their old setting until their VOC is updated. Until then, `term windows` sets it for the session.

What ships

63 terminfo definitions ship with SD, compiling to **100 terminal names** — the extra names are variants. For example, `vt100-w` and `vt220-at` are aliases that map to the same definition as their base name.

Common names that work out of the box: `windows`, `linux`, `vt100`, `vt220`, `wyse60`, `ansi`, `xterm`.

A name that is not installed is refused and your current type is kept:

```
:term vt320
Unrecognised terminal name
```

There is no plain `vt320` — the shipped name is `vt320-at`.

Setting the terminal

```
term                * report current type and page size
term windows        * set for this session
term 120,36          * set page size
term default         * restore 120 x 36 (prints nothing; check with bare term)
```

The page size is worked out at login in this order:

1. the `LINES` and `COLUMNS` environment variables if they are numeric
2. the terminfo entry's `lines` and `cols`
3. otherwise 36 and 120

A console or ssh session normally gets its real window size. 120 × 36 is the fallback when nothing answers — a phantom or a piped script.

The page is 120 × 36

SD's default is **120 columns by 36 lines**, not 80 × 24. The shipped dictionary records and the default `list` report layouts are formatted for 120 columns. A console window narrower than that makes ordinary reports look wrapped or truncated — which reads as a formatting bug and is not one.

The terminfo source

`terminfo.src` ships with SD. It is a text file containing all 63 definitions in source form. You can read it to see what a terminal definition looks like, and you can use it as a template for a custom definition.

Compiling a definition

The terminfo compiler ships with SD. `sdtic.exe` is in `C:\Program Files\SD\usr\bin`, beside `sd.exe`. Nothing needs building and nothing needs downloading.

```
sdtic {options} src...
```

<code>-d</code>	decompile a named terminal entry instead of compiling
<code>-i</code>	display an index of terminal names
<code>-p</code> <i>path</i>	use the terminfo library at <i>path</i>
<code>-t</code> <i>name</i>	compile only <i>name</i> ; may be repeated
<code>-v</code>	verbose
<code>-x</code>	do not overwrite entries that already exist

Without `-d` it compiles the source files you name. With `-d`, the argument is a terminal name to decompile rather than a file.

Two things follow from `-d` that are worth knowing. It is how you read a shipped definition without hunting through `terminfo.src`, and it is how you produce a starting point for a variant of one:

```
sdtic -d vt220 > myterm.src
```

Edit that, then compile it back in. `-x` is the safe form while you are experimenting, because it refuses to overwrite a definition that already exists.

The compiled definitions live under `C:\ProgramData\SD\sdsys\terminfo`, in single-letter directories by first letter. Writing there needs administrator rights, so run `sdtic` from an elevated prompt when you are adding a definition for the machine.